

China Internship OS — Workflow Guide

How to run the tool from your terminal, find internship postings, and take each one from capture to offer. Written for the Phase 1 tool running on your Claude subscription through the Claude Code CLI.

Two rules shape everything below. First, the tool never sends, submits or posts anything: it drafts text that you copy and send yourself. Second, nothing an AI model extracts is used for any decision until you have confirmed it field by field.

Contents

1. What the tool does and does not do
2. One-time setup
3. Every session: start here
4. Finding postings (done by you, outside the tool)
5. Capture a posting
6. Confirm the extraction
7. Read the result and rate the job
8. Ask the employer about YES and update the company
9. Move the job through the pipeline
10. Generate application material
11. Contacts and follow-ups
12. Dates, SUTD approval and the timeline
13. The dashboard
14. Weekly routine
15. Command reference
16. Troubleshooting

1. What the tool does and does not do

The tool is a local command-line program (**ios**) plus an optional dashboard. It keeps one SQLite database of jobs, companies, contacts and events on your Mac. Nothing leaves your machine except the job-description text you paste, which goes to Claude through the Claude Code CLI on your subscription.

It does	It does not
Extract structured fields from a pasted job description (LLM, Sonnet)	Search job sites or scrape anything (you browse and paste)
Let you confirm or correct every extracted field	Use unconfirmed AI output for any decision
Check your eligibility against the posting (deterministic rules)	Send messages, emails or applications
Check programme compatibility: YES, SUTD, host, dates, immigration	Decide the programme rules itself (they live in config/programme_constraints.yaml)
Rank jobs into tiers T1 / T2 / T3 / HOLD	Rank by title wording or by AI versus SWE
Draft recruiter messages, referral requests, resume bullets, a YES explanation and interview prep (LLM, Opus)	Invent facts about you: every claim must cite your evidence file or user facts

It does	It does not
Plan the visa and contract deadlines backwards from your start date	Delete jobs or companies (closed ones get a terminal status)

2. One-time setup

Run these once. You already did most of this; keep it for a fresh machine.

```
cd ~/jaelucard.github.io/china-internship-os
git pull
python3 -m venv .venv
source .venv/bin/activate
pip install -e ".[dev]"
ios init          # creates db.sqlite and config/user_facts.yaml (from the example)
ios llm-check     # expects: logged in: True
pytest -q        # expects: all tests passed
```

Then open `config/user_facts.yaml` and make every value true for you: cohort (2028届), expected graduation, exchange end date, intended start (2027-03-01), personal offer deadline, the Mandarin wording, GitHub and LinkedIn. The `llm:` block must read:

```
llm:
  provider: claude_code
  models:
    extraction: sonnet
    drafting: opus
  allow_resume_upload: false
  max_wait_minutes: null
```

If `ios llm-check` says the CLI is missing, install Claude Code (`curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash`) and run `claude auth login`, choosing your Claude subscription. No API key is used anywhere.

Also review `config/skill_evidence.yaml`: it is the only source the drafts may cite. Add projects as you finish them; keep the restrictions honest (for example, no figures from the MINDEF role).

3. Every session: start here

```
cd ~/jaelucard.github.io/china-internship-os
source .venv/bin/activate
ios digest
```

The digest prints, in order: the contract-by deadline and which lead times are still placeholders, programme constraints that need verifying, counts by tier and status, deadlines within 7 days, actions that are due today, and up to three recommended jobs to work on. Read it before anything else.

4. Finding postings (done by you, outside the tool)

The tool has no search feature by design: the job sites need login and forbid scraping. You browse, you judge, you copy the text. Budget one or two focused sessions a week rather than daily scrolling.

Where to look

Source	Use it for	Capture with --source
实习僧 (shixiseng.com)	Largest 日常实习 board; filter by city and 日常实习	shixiseng

Source	Use it for	Capture with --source
BOSS直聘	Direct chat with recruiters; many startup roles	boss
牛客 (nowcoder)	Tech-company campus and intern posts, referral threads	niuke
脉脉	Referrals (内推) and insider information	maimai
YES portal (yes.businesschina.org.sg)	Hosts already in the scheme; check weekly	yes_portal
Company career pages	Startups and subsidiaries you already like	company_site
LinkedIn	MNC subsidiaries in Shanghai/Hangzhou	linkedin
WeChat groups, alumni, professors, MolarData contacts	Warm leads; often the best hit rate	wechat / referral

What to search for

Combine a role phrase with a city and 日常实习. Examples that match your evidence: AI应用开发 实习 杭州, 大模型应用 实习生 上海, 后端开发 实习 杭州, LLM 应用 日常实习, Python 开发实习生 苏州. Add 内推 on 牛客 and 脉脉 to find referral threads.

Read the posting for these facts before you bother capturing it

- Cohort: does it say 2028届, 2027届/2028届, 毕业时间不限, or something that excludes you? Anything that says only 2027届 will be marked ineligible.
- Degree: 本科及以上 is fine; 硕士及以上 or 博士 makes the job ineligible.
- Duration and start: you need 4 to 6 months starting around March 2027. 实习期固定3个月 will be flagged AT_RISK; 6个月以上 as a minimum is also AT_RISK.
- Days per week: 4 or 5 is normal; more than 5 is flagged.
- City: Hangzhou and Shanghai are primary, Suzhou and Nanjing secondary, Ningbo, Wuxi and Jiaxing expanded. Anywhere else is HOLD.
- Nationality wording: 仅限中国籍 or 不提供签证支持 makes it ineligible; silence is not a problem.
- Host type: SUTD prefers startups and subsidiaries; large companies are allowed as fallback. It only affects sort order.

If it passes that glance, select the whole posting text (title, company, location, 岗位职责, 任职要求, 薪资, 投递方式) and copy it.

5. Capture a posting

```
ios capture --paste --source shixiseng
# paste the text, press Enter, then Ctrl-D
```

Alternatives: `ios capture --text-file jd.txt --source boss` for text saved to a file, or `ios capture --url https://... --source company_site` for a public page (one GET; if the page needs login the tool tells you to paste instead).

One Sonnet call runs and every field is stored as unconfirmed. You will see:

```
Captured job 7: 后端开发实习生 (status DISCOVERED, next: confirm extraction)
Run: ios confirm 7
```

Duplicate detected? The tool never merges silently. It shows the existing job and asks: 1 attach this capture as a note to the existing job, 2 create a separate job, 3 cancel. Same company, same title and same city, or the same URL, count as duplicates.

6. Confirm the extraction

`ios confirm 7`

A table shows every field with its value and the verbatim sentence from the posting that supports it. Check the value against the span. Then you are asked field by field:

You type	Effect
Enter	confirm the shown value
a new value	override it (dates as 2026-10-15, booleans true/false, lists as a, b, c or ["a", "b"])
-	set it to null
a	accept this and every remaining field

Fields worth a real look: cohort_years and cohort_unrestricted, degree_required, duration_min/max_months, start_date, deadline, nationality_or_work_auth_restriction, required_skills. If the company name came back empty you will be asked to type it.

On finishing, the tool links or creates the company (asking you if a similar name exists), runs eligibility, programme compatibility and tiering, and asks Claude for a quality checklist. Example result:

Confirmed job 7: 后端开发实习生 @ 苏州云栈软件有限公司
eligibility: LIKELY_ELIGIBLE | programme: AT_RISK | tier: T3
status: DISCOVERED | next: assess fit (2026-09-13)
SUTD_APPROVAL: LIKELY YES_ELIGIBILITY: CONFIRMED HOST_COMPANY: UNKNOWN
DURATION_AND_DATES: AT_RISK IMMIGRATION: LIKELY

If the job is ineligible (wrong cohort, master's required, PRC nationals only, deadline passed, role closed) it moves straight to the terminal status INELIGIBLE with tier HOLD, and you stop here.

7. Read the result and rate the job

`ios job show 7`

What the fields mean

Field	Values	Meaning
eligibility	ELIGIBLE / LIKELY_ELIGIBLE / UNCERTAIN / INELIGIBLE	Deterministic check of the posting against your facts. Soft flags (skill gaps, fluent Chinese asked, more than 5 days a week) give LIKELY_ELIGIBLE or UNCERTAIN; they never fail you.
programme	CONFIRMED / LIKELY / UNKNOWN / AT_RISK / INCOMPATIBLE per dimension; overall is the worst	YES_ELIGIBILITY and IMMIGRATION are about you and are already settled. HOST_COMPANY is UNKNOWN until the employer says whether they will host under YES. DURATION_AND_DATES compares the posting's months and start date with 4 to 6 months from March 2027.
fit	strong / ok / weak	Your judgement after reading the JD and the skill comparison in fit.md.
quality	strong / ok / weak / unknown	Your judgement, informed by the checklist Claude ticked (production code, APIs, LLM integration, testing... versus annotation, vague 'assist with AI').
tier	T1 / T2 / T3 / HOLD	T1 needs eligible + quality strong + fit strong or ok. HOLD means ineligible, incompatible host, or a city outside the region. Programme UNKNOWN alone never holds a job.

Set your two ratings; each reruns tiering and prints the new tier:

```
ios job fit 7 strong
ios job quality 7 ok
```

Tier order decides the digest's recommendations: T1 before T2 before T3; within a tier, earliest deadline first, then startup before subsidiary before large, then AI before SWE.

8. Ask the employer about YES and update the company

Every job starts with `HOST_COMPANY = UNKNOWN`, which keeps it out of `READY_TO_APPLY`. You resolve it by asking the employer. Generate the explanation text first:

```
ios job messages 7
```

Sections 5 and 6 of the resulting `messages.md` are a Chinese and an English explanation of what hosting under YES involves, built only from verified programme statements. Send it yourself through whatever channel you are talking to them on. Record the answer:

```
ios company set 3 --yes-status willing # or listed_on_yes, unwilling, confirmed
ios company set 3 --host-type startup # startup | subsidiary | large | mnc | unknown
ios company set 3 --note "HR 王女士 says they hosted a Singaporean intern in 2025"
ios recompute
```

`ios recompute` reruns eligibility, programme and tiering for every active job without calling Claude. `willing` or `listed_on_yes` makes `HOST_COMPANY` `LIKELY`; `unwilling` makes the job `INCOMPATIBLE` and `HOLD` (you can still keep it as a record).

9. Move the job through the pipeline

Status	When	Command
DISCOVERED	captured and confirmed	automatic
SHORTLISTED	you intend to pursue it	ios job status 7 SHORTLISTED --next "ask HR about YES" --due 2026-09-20
PROGRAMME_CHECK_REQUIRED	you tried <code>READY_TO_APPLY</code> while a programme dimension is <code>UNKNOWN</code> or <code>INCOMPATIBLE</code>	automatic; next action names the dimension to resolve
READY_TO_APPLY	programme is <code>LIKELY</code> or <code>CONFIRMED</code> (<code>AT_RISK</code> passes with a warning)	ios job status 7 READY_TO_APPLY --next "submit on 实习僧" --due 2026-09-22
APPLIED	you submitted the application yourself	ios job status 7 APPLIED --next "follow up with HR" --due 2026-09-29
IN_PROCESS	any interview stage; keep the stage in --stage	ios job status 7 IN_PROCESS --next "prepare interview" --due 2026-10-03 --stage "technical interview 1"
OFFER	offer received	ios job status 7 OFFER --next "send contract to SUTD" --due 2026-10-10
REJECTED / WITHDRAWN / CLOSED / INELIGIBLE	terminal; no next action needed	ios job status 7 REJECTED --note "HR: cohort mismatch"

Every active job must carry a next action and a due date; the tool refuses to save one without them. That is what makes the digest's 'actions due' list trustworthy. Moving to `INELIGIBLE` by hand requires `--note`.

10. Generate application material

All files land in `packs/<company>--<title>/`, which is gitignored. Each command also prints its output.

Command	Produces	Notes
<code>ios job pack 7</code>	<code>job.md</code> (confirmed fields plus raw JD), <code>fit.md</code> (eligibility reasons, programme dimensions, skill comparison table, strengths), <code>checklist.md</code> (application steps, documents, job timeline, contract-by date)	No Claude call. Read <code>fit.md</code> before rating fit.
<code>ios job messages 7</code>	<code>messages.md</code> : recruiter message zh/en, referral request zh/en, YES explanation zh/en	Opus. Chinese messages at most 150 characters, English at most 120 words. Every factual sentence carries an HTML comment naming its source; delete the comments before sending. Sentences with no valid source are dropped and listed under 'Refused statements'.
<code>ios job bullets 7</code>	<code>bullets.md</code> : 4 to 6 resume bullets tailored to the required skills, each ending in an evidence id like <code>[EV_F1_DASHBOARD]</code>	Opus. Invalid bullets (no id, unknown id, a digit in a MINDEF bullet) are dropped and reported, never kept.
<code>ios job interview-prep 7</code>	<code>interview-prep.md</code> : likely technical and behavioural questions, evidence to rehearse	Only when status is <code>IN_PROCESS</code> .

Mandarin is always described with the exact wording from your user facts (中文可作为工作语言 (非母语)). The drafts can never claim native Mandarin.

11. Contacts and follow-ups

```
ios contact add --company 3 --name "王女士" --role HR --channel wechat
ios contact touch 1 --next 2026-09-27 # records today as last contact, sets the follow-up date
ios contact list --company 3
ios job note 7 "HR replied: they will check with their HR head about YES"
```

12. Dates, SUTD approval and the timeline

```
ios timeline # or: ios timeline --job 7
```

The timeline works backwards from your intended start (or the job's agreed start): fly 3 days before, Z visa submitted before that, entry permit before that, LOC before that, contract before that. With today's placeholders the top line reads:

```
CONTRACT MUST BE SIGNED BY 2027-01-10 (N days). Placeholders in use: Z_VISA_EMBASSY_LEAD_TIME, EN
```

Three lead times are placeholders until Business China and the visa centre answer. When they do, edit `config/programme_constraints.yaml`: set `value_days`, the status, source and `date_verified` on `LOC_LEAD_TIME`, `ENTRY_PERMIT_LEAD_TIME` and `Z_VISA_EMBASSY_LEAD_TIME`. `ios constraints` lists every constraint that is unverified or past its verification date.

When an employer agrees on dates and when SUTD approves the host:

```
ios job dates 7 --start 2027-03-01 --months 5 # employer-agreed; the JD's stated start is left
ios job approve-sutd 7 # after SUTD confirms this host
```

Agreed dates within 4 to 6 months and not before your intended start make `DURATION_AND_DATES` `CONFIRMED`; SUTD approval makes `SUTD_APPROVAL` `CONFIRMED`. Both survive `ios recompute`.

13. The dashboard

```
streamlit run app.py
```

A read-mostly page with four blocks: programme status (contract-by line, constraint table with overdue verifications highlighted), the job table with tier/status/track/city filters and a detail view on row selection, active next actions with overdue ones first, and a capture form. Confirmation and editing stay in the terminal.

14. Weekly routine

When	Do
Start of every session	ios digest; work the 'actions due' list top to bottom.
Twice a week, 45 minutes	Search 实习僧 and BOSS with the phrases in section 4; capture and confirm anything that passes the glance test. Aim for 3 to 5 new captures a week, not 30.
After each confirmation	ios job pack, read fit.md, set fit and quality. Shortlist or close.
For every shortlisted job	Send the YES explanation, record the answer with ios company set, ios recompute, then move to READY_TO_APPLY and apply yourself the same day.
After applying	ios job status APPLIED with a follow-up date one week out. Log replies with ios job note.
Weekly	ios constraints: chase the three placeholder lead times (Business China, CVASC). Every day they stay placeholders the 2027-01-10 contract date is a guess.
Before 2026-12-11	Your personal offer deadline. The timeline warns if the contract-by date moves earlier than this.

15. Command reference

Command	Purpose
ios init	Create the database and user_facts.yaml if absent
ios llm-check	Show provider, models, and whether the claude CLI is installed and logged in
ios capture --paste --text-file F --url U --source S	Capture one posting (S: yes_portal, company_site, boss, shixiseng, niuke, maimai, linkedin, wechat, referral, xiaohongshu, other)
ios confirm ID	Field-by-field confirmation, company link, checks
ios job show ID / ios job list [--tier T1] [--status X] [--track AI] [--city 杭州]	Inspect one job / list sorted by tier
ios job fit ID strong ok weak / ios job quality ID strong ok weak unknown	Your ratings; rerun tiering
ios job status ID STATE --next "..." --due YYYY-MM-DD [--stage ...] [--note ...]	Pipeline transition (gated for READY_TO_APPLY)
ios job dates ID --start YYYY-MM-DD --months N	Employer-agreed dates
ios job approve-sutd ID	Record SUTD approval of the host
ios job note ID "..."	Add a note event
ios job pack ID / messages ID / bullets ID / interview-prep ID	Application material into packs/
ios company set ID --host-type ... --yes-status ... --note ...	Update the company
ios contact add / list / touch	Contacts and follow-up dates

Command	Purpose
ios recompute	Rerun all deterministic checks (no Claude)
ios timeline [--job ID] / ios constraints / ios digest	Planning views
streamlit run app.py	Dashboard

16. Troubleshooting

Symptom	What it means / what to do
command not found: ios	Run source .venv/bin/activate from the project directory first.
Configuration is invalid: file / key / problem	Open the named file and fix the named key. Old llm keys (provider: anthropic, model, allow_resume_upload_to_api) must become the block in section 2.
claude_code rate limit hit; waiting 60 s before retry	Your subscription's 5-hour or weekly limit was reached. The command waits and retries until it resets; Ctrl-C to stop and rerun later. Set llm.max_wait_minutes to cap the wait.
not logged in / could not determine login state	Run claude auth login and pick your Claude subscription, then ios llm-check.
URL capture failed: ... paste the job description text instead	The page needs login or has no readable JD. Copy the text and use --paste.
Possible duplicate	Choose attach, new job or cancel. Nothing is merged automatically.
Refused unsourced claim: ...	A drafted sentence had no valid evidence id or user-facts key, or claimed native Mandarin. It was dropped; the rest of the message stands.
job N status: ... -> PROGRAMME_CHECK_REQUIRED (refused READY_TO_APPLY)	A programme dimension is UNKNOWN or INCOMPATIBLE, usually HOST_COMPANY. Resolve it (ios company set, ios recompute) and try again.
Tier is HOLD	Ineligible, incompatible host, or city outside the region. ios job show ID lists the reason.